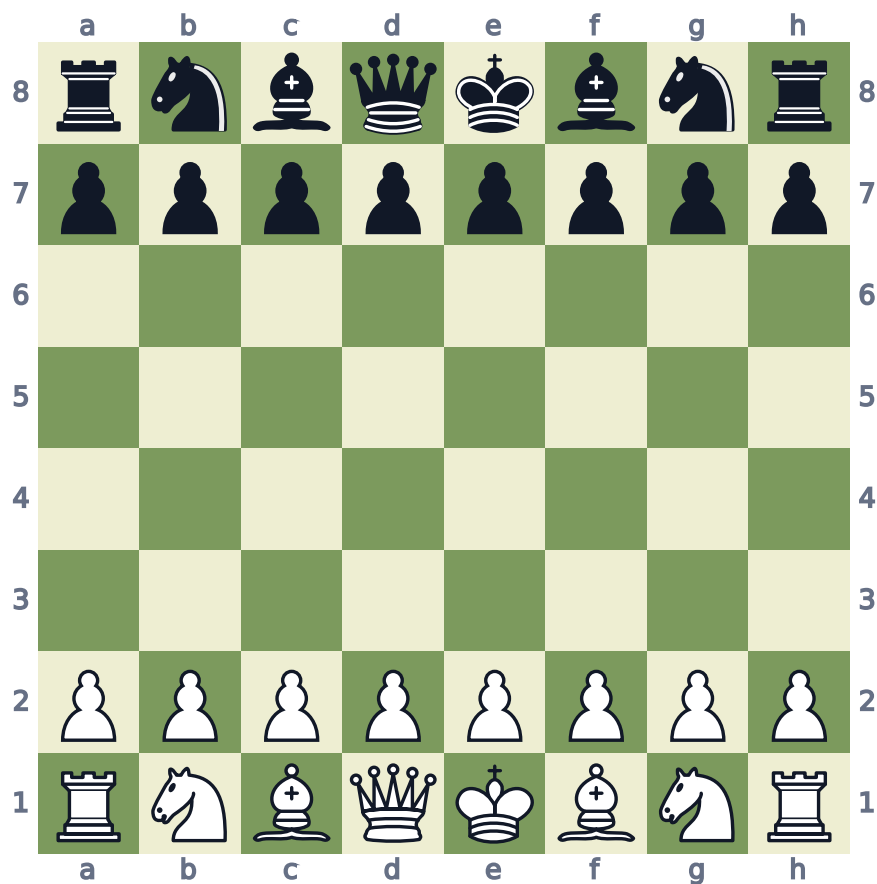


Annotated Model-Game Laboratories

Twelve thematic games and a method for learning from them



Study complete strategic stories instead of isolated moves: opening purpose, structural transition, piece improvement, tactical turning point, and end-of-line evaluation.

12 learning units | explanations | board laboratories | review system

ORIENTATION

What this course will change

COURSE PROMISE

Study complete strategic stories instead of isolated moves: opening purpose, structural transition, piece improvement, tactical turning point, and end-of-line evaluation.

YOU WILL LEARN TO

- Pause and predict at critical moments
- Explain moves by function
- Extract reusable patterns
- Build personal model-game cards

HOW TO USE THE COURSE

- Study one learning unit at a time. Say the rule in your own words before continuing.
- At each diagram, hide the model answer. Write candidates and the opponent's best reply.
- Use the rule during a slow game, then record whether it actually changed a decision.
- Review after 1, 3, 7, 14, and 30 days. Retrieval matters more than rereading.

SCOPE

This course contains 12 integrated learning units. Principles guide attention, but tactics and exact calculation always decide the move.

CORE METHOD

The decision protocol

USE THIS EVERY TIME

A reliable process is more valuable than a brilliant idea used occasionally. Practice the sequence until it becomes automatic under clock pressure.

1**Name the pawn structure.****2****Identify each side's best and worst pieces.****3****Locate thematic breaks.****4****Predict the next plan before revealing it.****5****Store the position as a pattern, not a string of moves.****STOPPING RULE**

Choose when one candidate is sufficiently verified for the clock situation. Before moving, inspect the position once from the opponent's perspective.

MODEL LABORATORY 01

Italian Game

STRATEGIC STORY

Fast development and a direct contest for d4 and f7.

TEACHING SEQUENCE

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Bc5 4. c3 Nf6 5. d4 exd4 6. cxd4 Bb4+ 7. Bd2 Bxd2+ 8. Nbx d2 d5

WHAT EACH SIDE IS TRYING TO BUILD

White: Build d4, castle, connect the rooks, and use e5 or d5 when the center allows it.

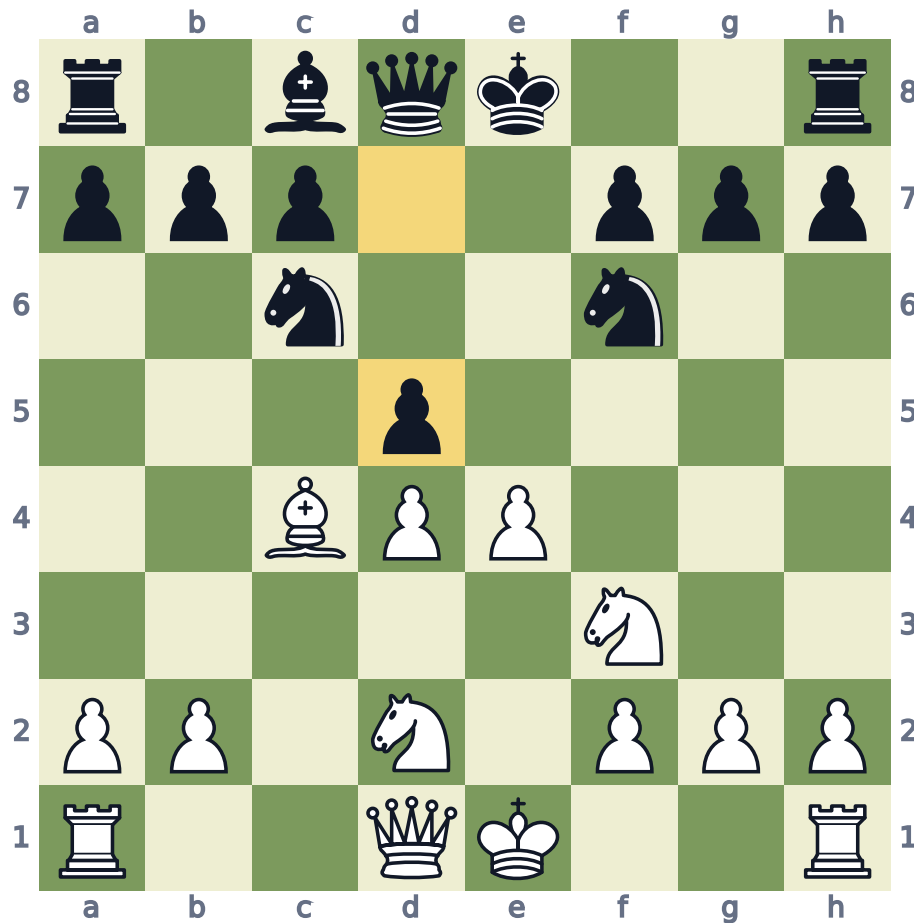
Black: Meet d4 in the center, finish development, and avoid passive defense around f7.

PREDICTION PAUSE

Before viewing the next page, set up the final position. Name the pawn structure, worst piece for each side, thematic break, and the opponent's most active reply.

MODEL LABORATORY 01

The transition position



POSITION MAP

Pawn break: White's d4 is the main freeing break; Black often answers with ...d5. Motif: Pressure on f7, a central fork on e5, and pins on the e-file after castling. Common mistake: Attacking f7 repeatedly while the king remains in the center. Memory cue: Develop, build d4, castle, then attack.

MODEL LABORATORY 01

Move functions and retrieval prompts

CRITICAL MOMENT 1: 3. Bc4

Bc4 develops or redirects a bishop onto a useful diagonal.

CRITICAL MOMENT 2: 5. D4

d4 contests central space and changes lines for the pieces.

CRITICAL MOMENT 3: 7. Bd2

Bd2 develops or redirects a bishop onto a useful diagonal.

CRITICAL MOMENT 4: 8... D5

d5 contests central space and changes lines for the pieces.

STORE THE PATTERN

Write one card with the position on the front. On the back, record the structure, best piece, worst piece, pawn break, desired exchange, and one tactical motif. Retrieve after 3, 7, and 14 days.

MODEL LABORATORY 02

Ruy Lopez

STRATEGIC STORY

Long-term pressure on e5 created by pinning the c6-knight.

TEACHING SEQUENCE

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bb5 a6 4. Ba4 Nf6 5. O-O Be7 6. Re1 b5 7. Bb3 d6 8. c3 O-O 9. h3 Nb8

WHAT EACH SIDE IS TRYING TO BUILD

White: Prepare d4 with c3, preserve the light bishop, and improve pieces before opening the center.

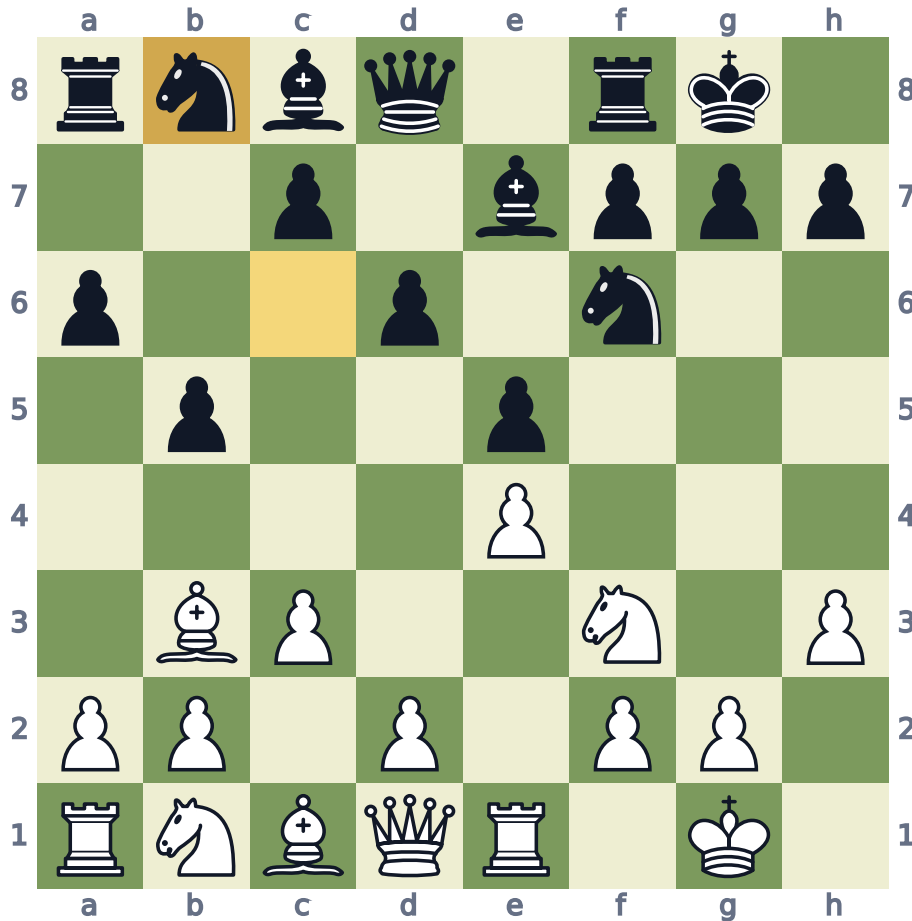
Black: Gain space with ...b5, defend e5, and reorganize the queenside knight toward d7.

PREDICTION PAUSE

Before viewing the next page, set up the final position. Name the pawn structure, worst piece for each side, thematic break, and the opponent's most active reply.

MODEL LABORATORY 02

The transition position



POSITION MAP

Pawn break: White wants d4; Black often seeks ...d5 after enough preparation. Motif: The e5 pawn can become loose when its knight defender is pinned or diverted. Common mistake: Taking c6 and e5 automatically without checking whether ...Qd4 or ...Qf6 regains the pawn. Memory cue: Pressure first, center second, tactics only when ready.

MODEL LABORATORY 02

Move functions and retrieval prompts

CRITICAL MOMENT 1: 3. BB5

Bb5 develops or redirects a bishop onto a useful diagonal.

CRITICAL MOMENT 2: 5... BE7

Be7 develops or redirects a bishop onto a useful diagonal.

CRITICAL MOMENT 3: 7... D6

d6 contests central space and changes lines for the pieces.

CRITICAL MOMENT 4: 9... NB8

Nb8 improves a knight's central influence or route to an outpost.

STORE THE PATTERN

Write one card with the position on the front. On the back, record the structure, best piece, worst piece, pawn break, desired exchange, and one tactical motif. Retrieve after 3, 7, and 14 days.

MODEL LABORATORY 03

King's Gambit

STRATEGIC STORY

White offers a pawn to pull Black's e-pawn away and accelerate an attack.

TEACHING SEQUENCE

1. e4 e5 2. f4 exf4 3. Nf3 g5 4. h4 g4 5. Ne5 Nf6 6. Bc4 d5 7. exd5 Bd6 8. d4 Nh5

WHAT EACH SIDE IS TRYING TO BUILD

White: Develop with tempo, recover control of the center, and open files toward the black king.

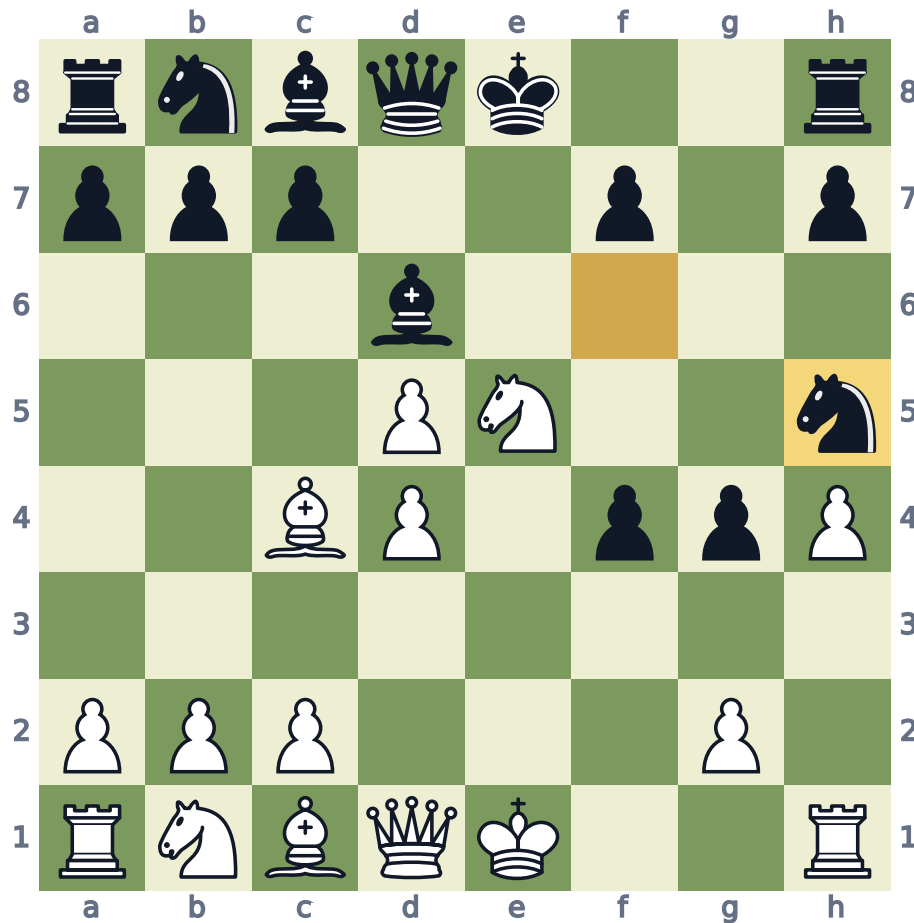
Black: Keep the extra pawn only when safe, counter in the center, and return material to finish development.

PREDICTION PAUSE

Before viewing the next page, set up the final position. Name the pawn structure, worst piece for each side, thematic break, and the opponent's most active reply.

MODEL LABORATORY 03

The transition position



POSITION MAP

Pawn break: White's d4 restores central control; Black's ...d5 challenges the attacking setup. Motif: Checks on h5 and sacrifices on f7 appear when Black's king and kingside pawns are stretched. Common mistake: Trying to win the f4-pawn back immediately instead of completing development. Memory cue: The pawn is an investment in time, not a debt.

MODEL LABORATORY 03

Move functions and retrieval prompts

CRITICAL MOMENT 1: 3. NF3

Nf3 improves a knight's central influence or route to an outpost.

CRITICAL MOMENT 2: 5. NE5

Ne5 improves a knight's central influence or route to an outpost.

CRITICAL MOMENT 3: 7. EXD5

exd5 changes the material or pawn structure and must be evaluated by the resulting position.

CRITICAL MOMENT 4: 8... NH5

Nh5 improves a knight's central influence or route to an outpost.

STORE THE PATTERN

Write one card with the position on the front. On the back, record the structure, best piece, worst piece, pawn break, desired exchange, and one tactical motif. Retrieve after 3, 7, and 14 days.

MODEL LABORATORY 04

Caro-Kann Defense

STRATEGIC STORY

Black builds a sound center while keeping the light bishop outside the pawn chain.

TEACHING SEQUENCE

1. e4 c6 2. d4 d5 3. e5 Bf5 4. Nf3 e6 5. Be2 c5 6. O-O Nc6 7. Be3 cxd4 8. Nxd4

WHAT EACH SIDE IS TRYING TO BUILD

White: Use space, develop without blocking the center, and respond accurately to ...c5.

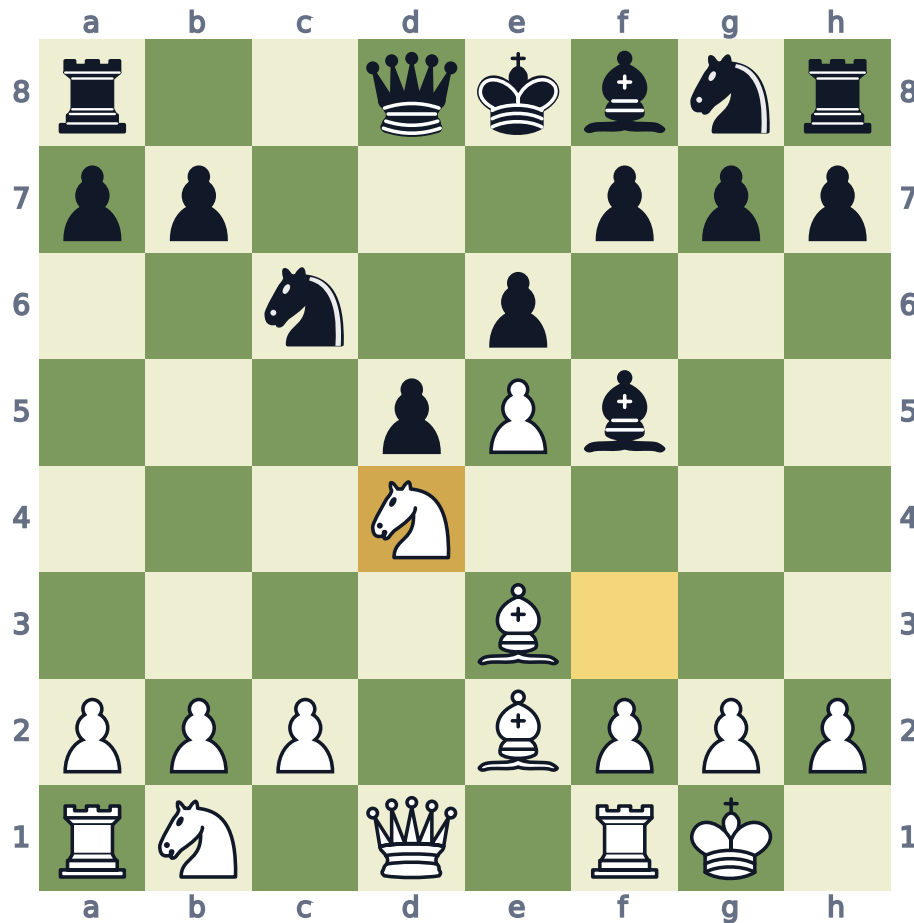
Black: Complete development, challenge d4, and avoid allowing e5 to become untouchable.

PREDICTION PAUSE

Before viewing the next page, set up the final position. Name the pawn structure, worst piece for each side, thematic break, and the opponent's most active reply.

MODEL LABORATORY 04

The transition position



POSITION MAP

Pawn break: ...c5 is the main equalizing lever; ...f6 may attack e5 later. Motif: The f5-bishop can be chased, but every pawn push leaves squares behind. Common mistake: Spending many tempi trapping the bishop while Black breaks open the center. Memory cue: Bishop out, center challenged, structure sound.

MODEL LABORATORY 04

Move functions and retrieval prompts

CRITICAL MOMENT 1: 2... D5

d5 contests central space and changes lines for the pieces.

CRITICAL MOMENT 2: 4... E6

e6 contests central space and changes lines for the pieces.

CRITICAL MOMENT 3: 6... Nc6

Nc6 improves a knight's central influence or route to an outpost.

CRITICAL MOMENT 4: 8. Nxd4

Nxd4 changes the material or pawn structure and must be evaluated by the resulting position.

STORE THE PATTERN

Write one card with the position on the front. On the back, record the structure, best piece, worst piece, pawn break, desired exchange, and one tactical motif. Retrieve after 3, 7, and 14 days.

MODEL LABORATORY 05

Sicilian Scheveningen

STRATEGIC STORY

Black's compact e6-d6 center controls key squares and invites a dynamic attack-counterattack battle.

TEACHING SEQUENCE

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 d6 3. d4 cxd4 4. Nxd4 Nf6 5. Nc3 e6 6. Be2 Be7 7. O-O O-O 8. f4 Nc6 9. Be3

WHAT EACH SIDE IS TRYING TO BUILD

White: Use f4, coordinate against the king, and watch the e5-square.

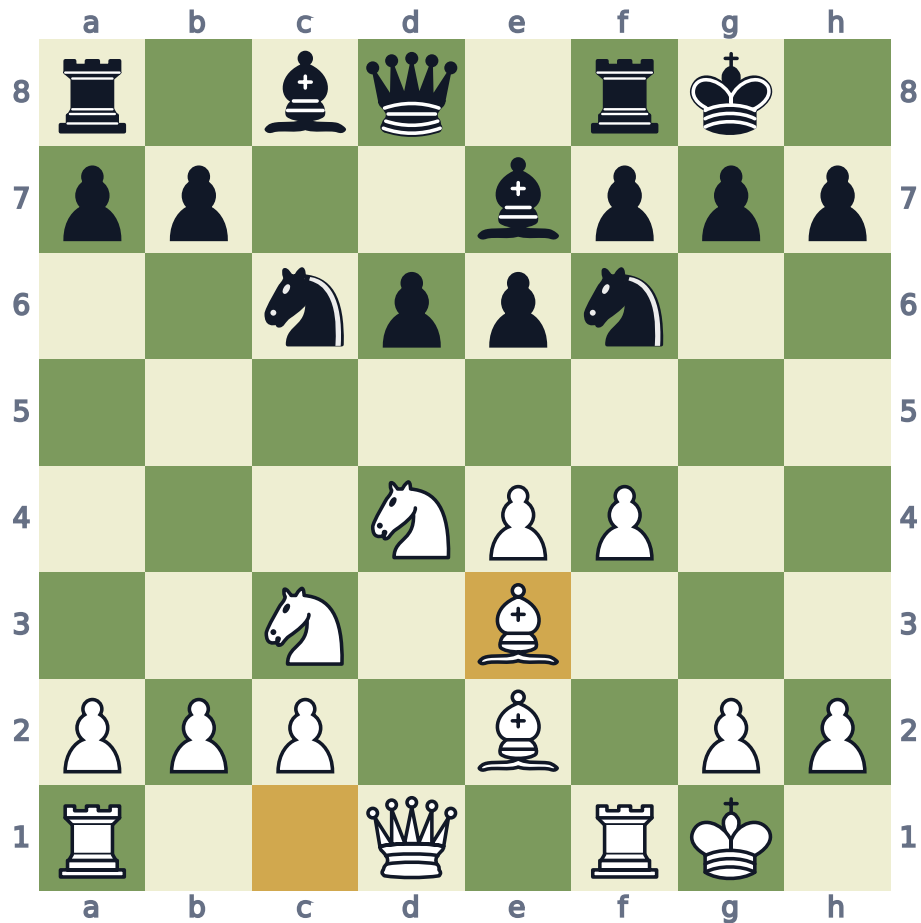
Black: Complete development, use ...Qc7 and ...b5, and time ...d5 precisely.

PREDICTION PAUSE

Before viewing the next page, set up the final position. Name the pawn structure, worst piece for each side, thematic break, and the opponent's most active reply.

MODEL LABORATORY 05

The transition position



POSITION MAP

Pawn break: White's f5 and Black's ...d5 or ...b5 are the critical levers. Motif: Sacrifices on e6 can open lines when the f-pawn, queen, and bishops are aligned. Common mistake: Pushing f5 before enough pieces can exploit the opened lines. Memory cue: Compact center, flexible counterpunch.

MODEL LABORATORY 05

Move functions and retrieval prompts

CRITICAL MOMENT 1: 3. D4

d4 contests central space and changes lines for the pieces.

CRITICAL MOMENT 2: 5. Nc3

Nc3 improves a knight's central influence or route to an outpost.

CRITICAL MOMENT 3: 7. O-O

O-O secures the king and activates a rook.

CRITICAL MOMENT 4: 9. Be3

Be3 develops or redirects a bishop onto a useful diagonal.

STORE THE PATTERN

Write one card with the position on the front. On the back, record the structure, best piece, worst piece, pawn break, desired exchange, and one tactical motif. Retrieve after 3, 7, and 14 days.

MODEL LABORATORY 06

Sicilian Alapin

STRATEGIC STORY

White prepares d4 with a pawn, aiming for a broad classical center.

TEACHING SEQUENCE

1. e4 c5 2. c3 Nf6 3. e5 Nd5 4. d4 cxd4 5. Nf3 Nc6 6. cxd4 d6 7. Bc4 dxe5 8. dxe5

WHAT EACH SIDE IS TRYING TO BUILD

White: Build the center, develop behind it, and use space without overprotecting every pawn.

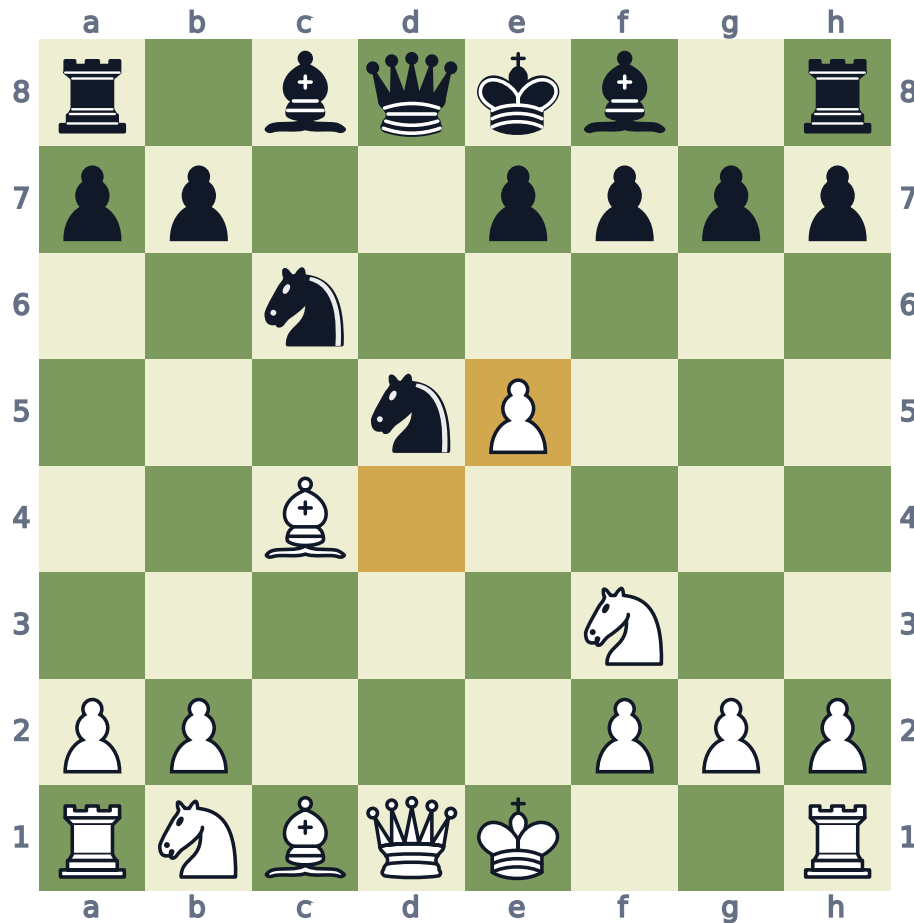
Black: Attack e4 immediately, exchange central pawns, and make White prove the center is stable.

PREDICTION PAUSE

Before viewing the next page, set up the final position. Name the pawn structure, worst piece for each side, thematic break, and the opponent's most active reply.

MODEL LABORATORY 06

The transition position



POSITION MAP

Pawn break: Black's ...d5 or ...d6 attacks the center; White may advance e5 for space. Motif: The advanced e5-pawn can gain time on a knight but can also become a target. Common mistake: Recapturing automatically without checking whether isolated pawns and piece activity favor Black. Memory cue: Build d4, then defend the center with pieces.

MODEL LABORATORY 06

Move functions and retrieval prompts

CRITICAL MOMENT 1: 2... Nf6

Nf6 improves a knight's central influence or route to an outpost.

CRITICAL MOMENT 2: 4... CXD4

cx d4 changes the material or pawn structure and must be evaluated by the resulting position.

CRITICAL MOMENT 3: 6... D6

d6 contests central space and changes lines for the pieces.

CRITICAL MOMENT 4: 8. DXE5

dx e5 changes the material or pawn structure and must be evaluated by the resulting position.

STORE THE PATTERN

Write one card with the position on the front. On the back, record the structure, best piece, worst piece, pawn break, desired exchange, and one tactical motif. Retrieve after 3, 7, and 14 days.

MODEL LABORATORY 07

Modern Defense

STRATEGIC STORY

Black delays committing the center and seeks flexible counterplay from a fianchetto.

TEACHING SEQUENCE

1. e4 g6 2. d4 Bg7 3. Nc3 d6 4. f4 a6 5. Nf3 b5 6. Bd3 Nd7 7. O-O Bb7 8. e5

WHAT EACH SIDE IS TRYING TO BUILD

White: Occupy the center, develop behind it, and expand only when the king is safe.

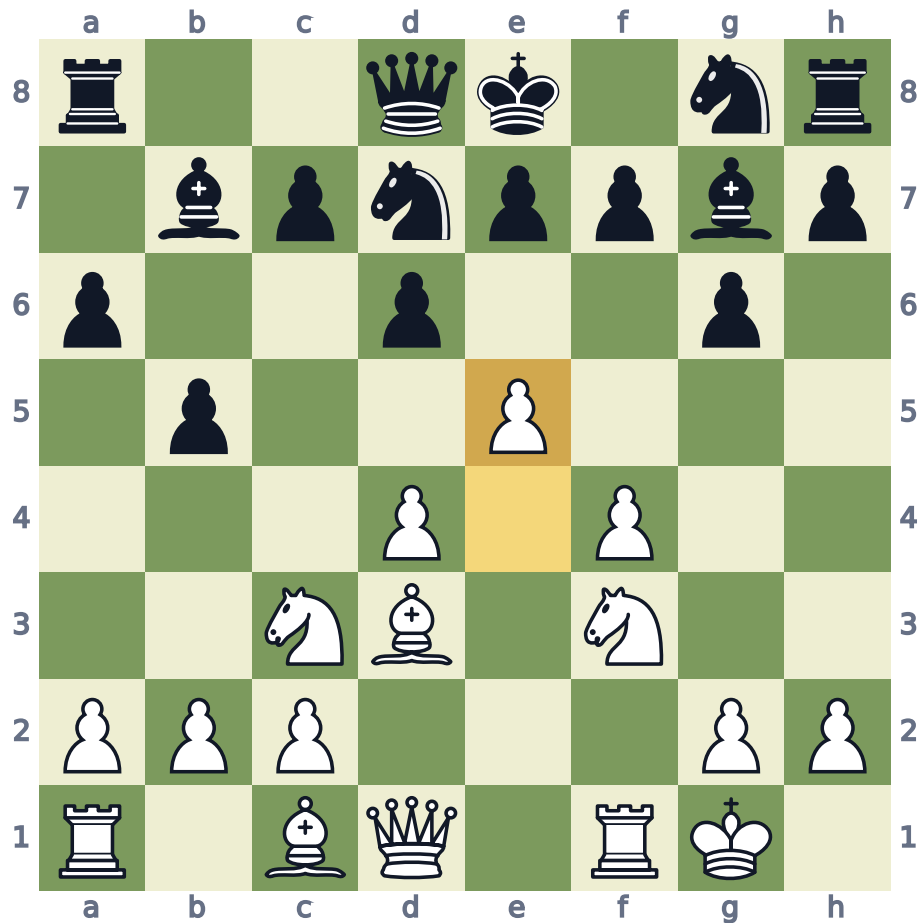
Black: Attack the center with ...c5 or ...e5 and use queenside space without neglecting development.

PREDICTION PAUSE

Before viewing the next page, set up the final position. Name the pawn structure, worst piece for each side, thematic break, and the opponent's most active reply.

MODEL LABORATORY 07

The transition position



POSITION MAP

Pawn break: ...c5 and ...e5 are Black's key choices; White's e5 can gain space and time. Motif: A queenside pawn advance can threaten ...b4, dislodging the defender of e4. Common mistake: Confusing flexibility with permission to leave pieces undeveloped. Memory cue: Delay commitment, not development forever.

MODEL LABORATORY 07

Move functions and retrieval prompts

CRITICAL MOMENT 1: 2... Bg7

Bg7 develops or redirects a bishop onto a useful diagonal.

CRITICAL MOMENT 2: 4... A6

a6 gains space or prepares a pawn lever, while permanently changing nearby squares.

CRITICAL MOMENT 3: 6... Nd7

Nd7 improves a knight's central influence or route to an outpost.

CRITICAL MOMENT 4: 8. E5

e5 contests central space and changes lines for the pieces.

STORE THE PATTERN

Write one card with the position on the front. On the back, record the structure, best piece, worst piece, pawn break, desired exchange, and one tactical motif. Retrieve after 3, 7, and 14 days.

MODEL LABORATORY 08

Slav Defense

STRATEGIC STORY

Black supports d5 with ...c6 while leaving the light bishop free.

TEACHING SEQUENCE

1. d4 d5 2. c4 c6 3. Nf3 Nf6 4. Nc3 dxc4 5. a4 Bf5 6. e3 e6 7. Bxc4 Bb4 8. O-O

WHAT EACH SIDE IS TRYING TO BUILD

White: Develop, recover c4 efficiently, and use e4 when the center permits it.

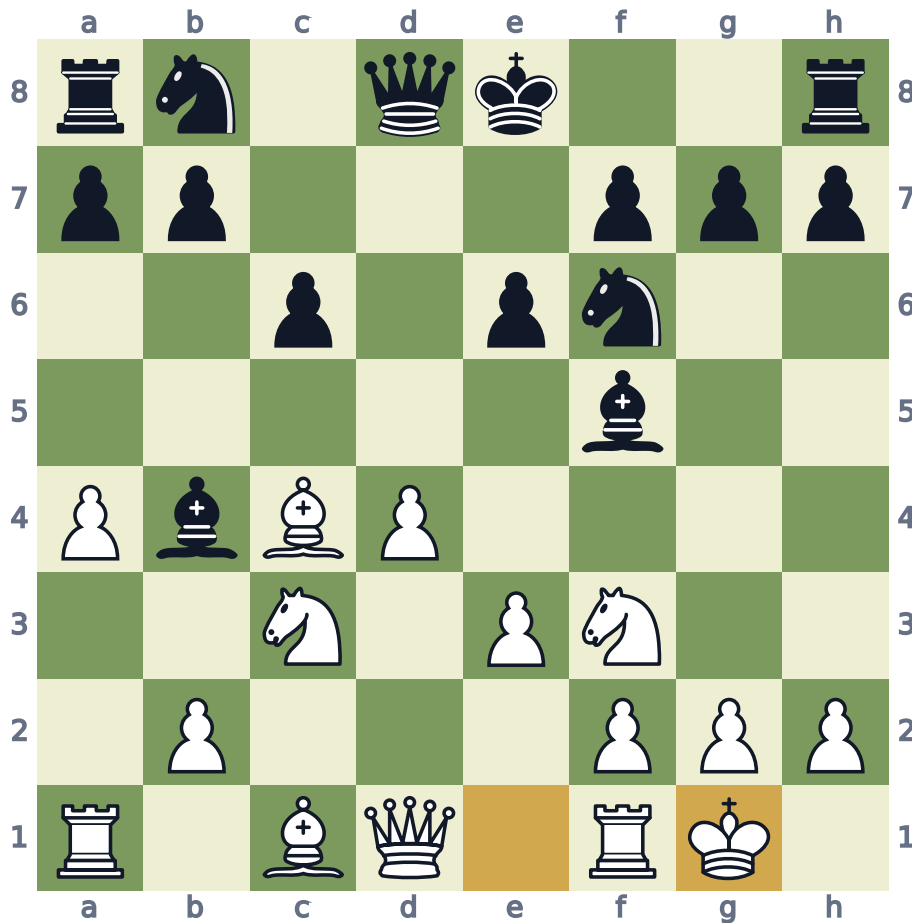
Black: Develop the bishop before ...e6, decide whether to hold c4 briefly, and challenge the center.

PREDICTION PAUSE

Before viewing the next page, set up the final position. Name the pawn structure, worst piece for each side, thematic break, and the opponent's most active reply.

MODEL LABORATORY 08

The transition position



POSITION MAP

Pawn break: Black's ...c5 or ...e5 is the long-term freeing goal. Motif: ...Bb4 can pin the c3-knight and increase pressure on e4 or c3. Common mistake: Holding the c4-pawn with many queenside moves while White gains a huge center. Memory cue: Support d5 without locking in the bishop.

MODEL LABORATORY 08

Move functions and retrieval prompts

CRITICAL MOMENT 1: 2... C6

c6 gains space or prepares a pawn lever, while permanently changing nearby squares.

CRITICAL MOMENT 2: 4... DXC4

dx4 changes the material or pawn structure and must be evaluated by the resulting position.

CRITICAL MOMENT 3: 6... E6

e6 contests central space and changes lines for the pieces.

CRITICAL MOMENT 4: 8. O-O

O-O secures the king and activates a rook.

STORE THE PATTERN

Write one card with the position on the front. On the back, record the structure, best piece, worst piece, pawn break, desired exchange, and one tactical motif. Retrieve after 3, 7, and 14 days.

MODEL LABORATORY 09

King's Indian Defense

STRATEGIC STORY

A closed center often produces White's queenside space against Black's kingside attack.

TEACHING SEQUENCE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Nf3 O-O 6. Be2 e5 7. O-O Nc6 8. d5 Ne7

WHAT EACH SIDE IS TRYING TO BUILD

White: Use queenside space, prepare c5, and slow Black's attack without losing the initiative.

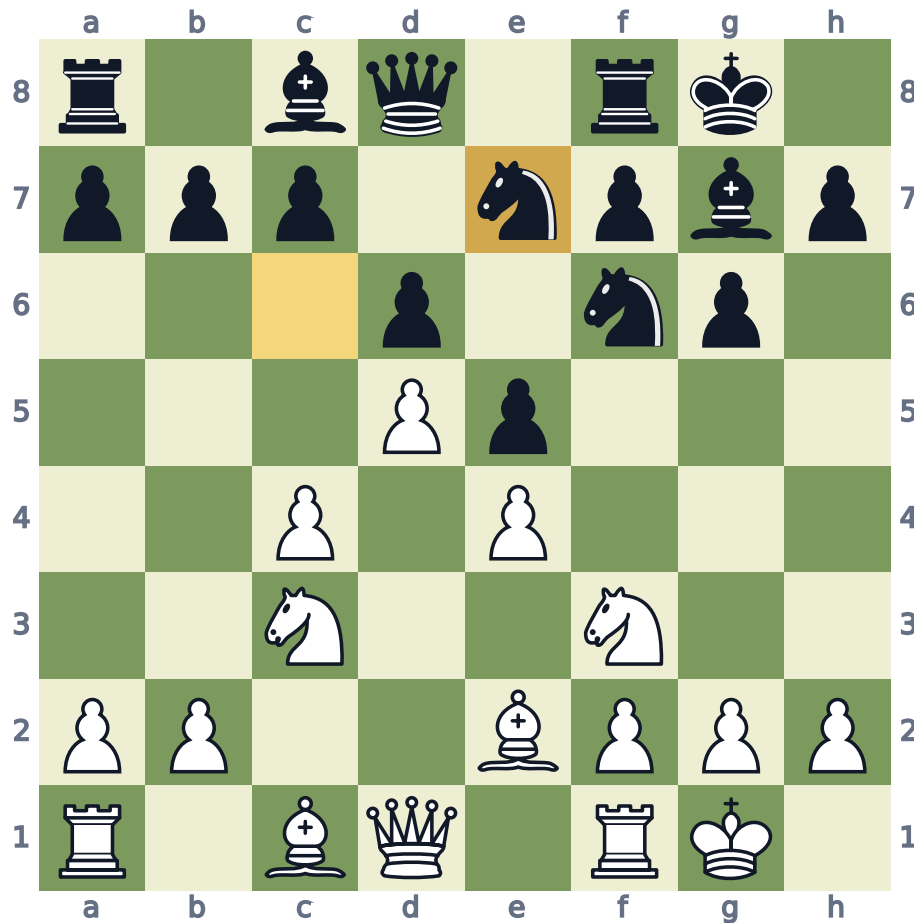
Black: Close with ...e5, maneuver, and break with ...f5 toward White's king.

PREDICTION PAUSE

Before viewing the next page, set up the final position. Name the pawn structure, worst piece for each side, thematic break, and the opponent's most active reply.

MODEL LABORATORY 09

The transition position



POSITION MAP

Pawn break: White's c5 and Black's ...f5 define the two-wing race. Motif: Knight maneuvers to g6 or h5 support ...f5; White often uses b4 and c5 to open files. Common mistake: Attacking on the wrong wing just because the pieces are nearby. Memory cue: Follow the pawn-chain arrows: White queenside, Black kingside.

MODEL LABORATORY 09

Move functions and retrieval prompts

CRITICAL MOMENT 1: 3. Nc3

Nc3 improves a knight's central influence or route to an outpost.

CRITICAL MOMENT 2: 5. Nf3

Nf3 improves a knight's central influence or route to an outpost.

CRITICAL MOMENT 3: 7. O-O

O-O secures the king and activates a rook.

CRITICAL MOMENT 4: 8... Ne7

Ne7 improves a knight's central influence or route to an outpost.

STORE THE PATTERN

Write one card with the position on the front. On the back, record the structure, best piece, worst piece, pawn break, desired exchange, and one tactical motif. Retrieve after 3, 7, and 14 days.

MODEL LABORATORY 10

English Opening

STRATEGIC STORY

White controls d5 from the flank and delays the final central structure.

TEACHING SEQUENCE

1. c4 e5 2. Nc3 Nf6 3. g3 d5 4. cxd5 Nxd5 5. Bg2 Nb6 6. Nf3 Nc6 7. O-O Be7

WHAT EACH SIDE IS TRYING TO BUILD

White: Fianchetto, finish development, and choose d4 or a queenside expansion based on Black's setup.

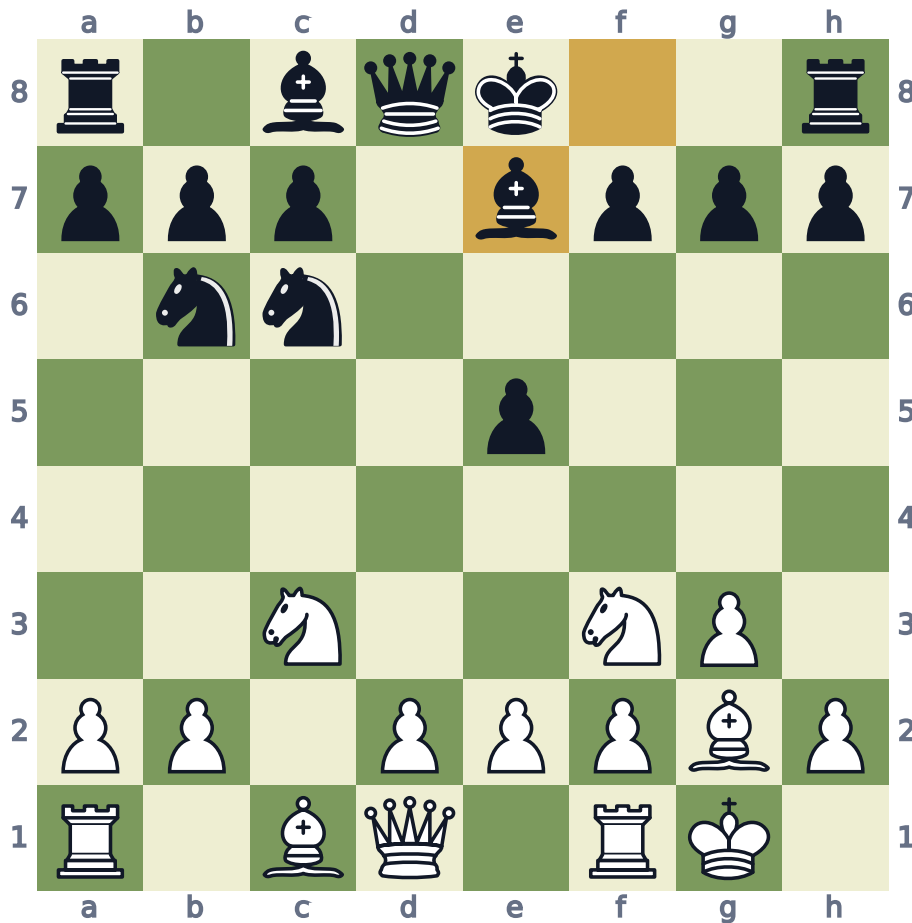
Black: Use central space, develop quickly, and prevent White from gaining a free d4 break.

PREDICTION PAUSE

Before viewing the next page, set up the final position. Name the pawn structure, worst piece for each side, thematic break, and the opponent's most active reply.

MODEL LABORATORY 10

The transition position



POSITION MAP

Pawn break: White's d4 transforms the position; Black may use ...f5 or ...d4. Motif: The g2-bishop and c-pawn combine against b7 and d5 when diagonals open. Common mistake: Playing a slow flank setup without watching Black occupy the whole center. Memory cue: Control the center from the side, then choose when to occupy it.

MODEL LABORATORY 10

Move functions and retrieval prompts

CRITICAL MOMENT 1: 2... Nf6

Nf6 improves a knight's central influence or route to an outpost.

CRITICAL MOMENT 2: 4... Nxd5

Nxd5 changes the material or pawn structure and must be evaluated by the resulting position.

CRITICAL MOMENT 3: 6. Nf3

Nf3 improves a knight's central influence or route to an outpost.

CRITICAL MOMENT 4: 7... Be7

Be7 develops or redirects a bishop onto a useful diagonal.

STORE THE PATTERN

Write one card with the position on the front. On the back, record the structure, best piece, worst piece, pawn break, desired exchange, and one tactical motif. Retrieve after 3, 7, and 14 days.

MODEL LABORATORY 11

Jobava London System

STRATEGIC STORY

White combines London development with Nc3 and tactical pressure on b5, c7, and d5.

TEACHING SEQUENCE

1. d4 d5 2. Nc3 Nf6 3. Bf4 c5 4. e3 Nc6 5. Nb5 e5 6. dxe5 Ne4 7. Qxd5

WHAT EACH SIDE IS TRYING TO BUILD

White: Develop energetically, watch the b5-knight jump, and calculate central tactics before routine setup moves.

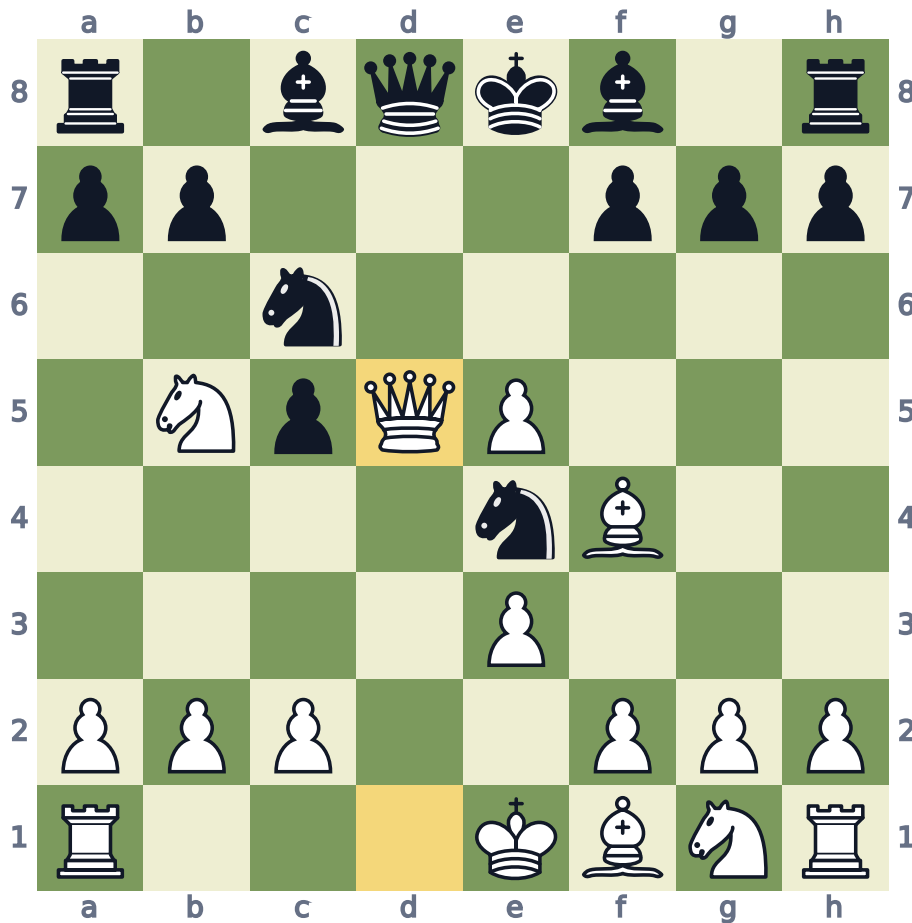
Black: Challenge d4 immediately, question the b5-knight, and avoid loose central pawns.

PREDICTION PAUSE

Before viewing the next page, set up the final position. Name the pawn structure, worst piece for each side, thematic break, and the opponent's most active reply.

MODEL LABORATORY 11

The transition position



POSITION MAP

Pawn break: Black's ...c5 and ...e5 attack the center; White can use Nb5 and dxc5 tactics. Motif: Nb5 often threatens Nc7+, so Black's queen and rook alignment matters. Common mistake: Playing Nb5 automatically when Black can chase it and gain tempi. Memory cue: Nc3 turns the London from a shell into a tactical system.

MODEL LABORATORY 11

Move functions and retrieval prompts

CRITICAL MOMENT 1: 2... Nf6

Nf6 improves a knight's central influence or route to an outpost.

CRITICAL MOMENT 2: 4. E3

e3 contests central space and changes lines for the pieces.

CRITICAL MOMENT 3: 5... E5

e5 contests central space and changes lines for the pieces.

CRITICAL MOMENT 4: 7. Qxd5

Qxd5 changes the material or pawn structure and must be evaluated by the resulting position.

STORE THE PATTERN

Write one card with the position on the front. On the back, record the structure, best piece, worst piece, pawn break, desired exchange, and one tactical motif. Retrieve after 3, 7, and 14 days.

MODEL LABORATORY 12

King's Indian Attack

STRATEGIC STORY

White uses a universal kingside fianchetto and prepares e4 without revealing the center early.

TEACHING SEQUENCE

1. Nf3 d5 2. g3 Nf6 3. Bg2 e6 4. O-O Be7 5. d3 O-O 6. Nbd2 c5 7. e4 Nc6 8. Re1

WHAT EACH SIDE IS TRYING TO BUILD

White: Establish e4, use e5 when it gains space, and build a kingside attack with coordinated pieces.

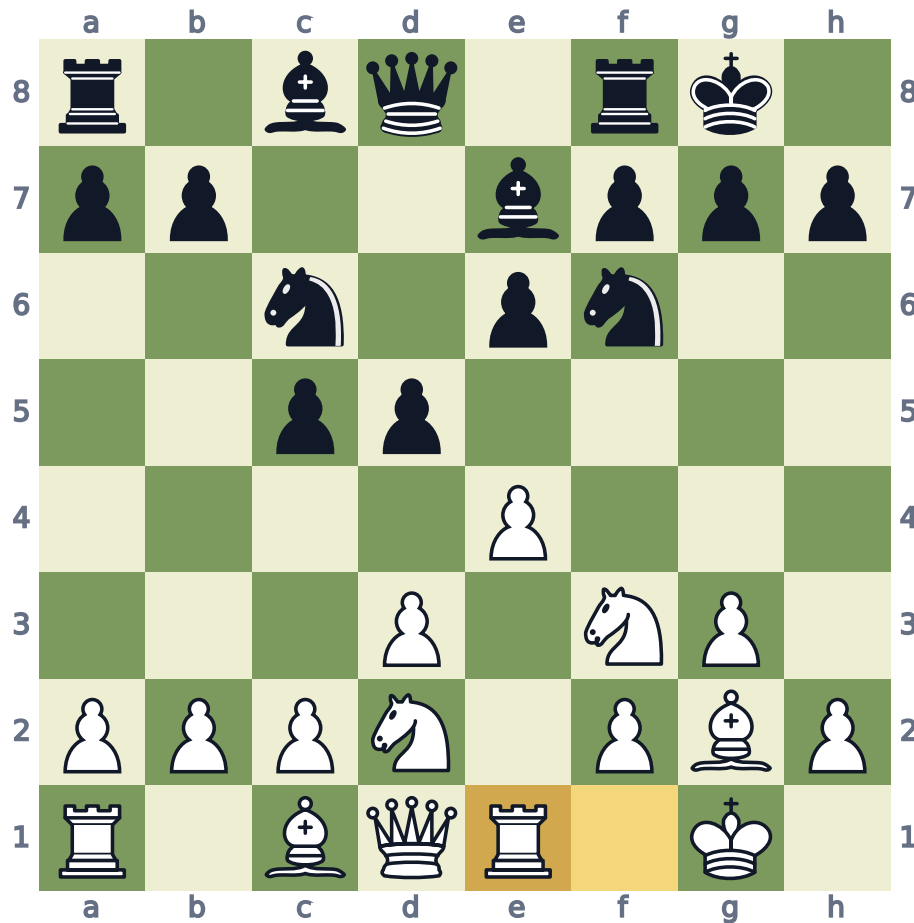
Black: Use central space, open the queenside, and challenge e4 before White's attack becomes automatic.

PREDICTION PAUSE

Before viewing the next page, set up the final position. Name the pawn structure, worst piece for each side, thematic break, and the opponent's most active reply.

MODEL LABORATORY 12

The transition position



POSITION MAP

Pawn break: White's e5 and later h4-h5 can attack; Black's ...d4 or ...b5 creates counterplay. Motif: A closed center can enable a knight transfer to f1-h2-g4 and an attack on the king. Common mistake: Following the setup mechanically when Black's center demands an immediate response. Memory cue: Build the shell, close with e5 when useful, then maneuver.

MODEL LABORATORY 12

Move functions and retrieval prompts

CRITICAL MOMENT 1: 2... Nf6

Nf6 improves a knight's central influence or route to an outpost.

CRITICAL MOMENT 2: 4... Be7

Be7 develops or redirects a bishop onto a useful diagonal.

CRITICAL MOMENT 3: 6... c5

c5 gains space or prepares a pawn lever, while permanently changing nearby squares.

CRITICAL MOMENT 4: 8. Re1

Re1 places a rook on a file or rank where entry and coordination may matter.

STORE THE PATTERN

Write one card with the position on the front. On the back, record the structure, best piece, worst piece, pawn break, desired exchange, and one tactical motif. Retrieve after 3, 7, and 14 days.

RETRIEVAL TEST

Can you explain the course without looking?

1

State the five-step decision protocol from memory.

2

Name three recognition cues that should make you slow down.

3

Choose five learning units and explain the causal mechanism behind each rule.

4

For each chosen rule, give one position where it should not be applied mechanically.

5

Describe the opponent's strongest practical resource in your most recent serious game.

6

Name one recurring error and the exact training drill that addresses its cause.

SCORING

2 points: accurate rule plus mechanism. 1 point: useful but incomplete. 0 points: slogan only. Restudy any item below 2 and retrieve it again tomorrow.

TRAINING PLAN

Four weeks to make the ideas usable

WEEK 1 - UNDERSTAND

Study the first quarter of the course. After every lesson, explain why the rule works and when it fails.

WEEK 2 - RECOGNIZE

Study the second quarter. Mix old and new diagrams so the name of the motif is not given in advance.

WEEK 3 - CALCULATE

Finish the course. Use a clock and write candidates, best defense, and endpoint evaluation.

WEEK 4 - TRANSFER

Play two slow games. Mark every moment when the course's protocol changed your decision, then analyze unaided.

LONG-TERM REVIEW

Return after 7, 14, and 30 days. Do not reread first. Attempt the retrieval test, review only missed items, and find one example from your own games.

REFERENCE

How this course fits the library

COURSE ROLE

Study complete strategic stories instead of isolated moves: opening purpose, structural transition, piece improvement, tactical turning point, and end-of-line evaluation.

LIBRARY PRINCIPLE

Strong chess comes from a loop: notice the right features, generate serious candidates, calculate the opponent's best resistance, evaluate the destination position, and learn from the decision process.

ABOUT THE DIAGRAMS

Boards use Cburnett-style vector chess pieces with solid dark pieces and high-contrast olive and cream squares. Piece artwork is credited to Colin M. L. Burnett and the Lichess Cburnett set under GPLv2+.

EDITION NOTES

First edition, September 2026. 12 learning units. Explanations and exercises are designed for personal study and should be tested against actual games and concrete calculation.

THE FINAL QUESTION

What will you do differently on your very next move? If the course has not changed a behavior, choose one rule, attach it to a visible board cue, and practice it in five slow games.